

MORMOOPIDAE

The family Mormoopidae contains the naked-backed and moustache bats. Several species have wings that join across their back and they have a fringe of stiff hairs around the muzzle.



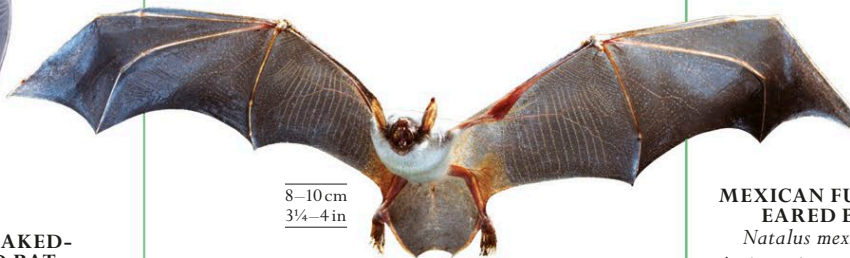
4.5–6 cm
2–2¼ in

DAVY'S NAKED-BACKED BAT
Pteronotus davyi

Unlike most other bats, this bat's wing membranes meet across its back. It is distributed from Mexico to S. America.

NOCTILIONIDAE

The two species of bulldog bats from the family Noctilionidae have long legs and large feet and claws. They have full lips and cheek pouches for storing food while flying.



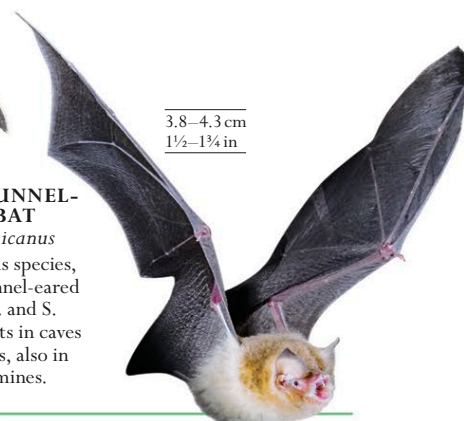
8–10 cm
3¼–4 in

GREATER BULLDOG BAT
Noctilio leporinus

Specialized for snatching fish from the water's surface with its claws, the greater bulldog or fishing bat lives in tropical C. and S. America.

NATALIDAE

The funnel-eared bats of the family Natalidae are small and slender with large ears. Adult males have a sensory structure, called a natalid organ, on their forehead.



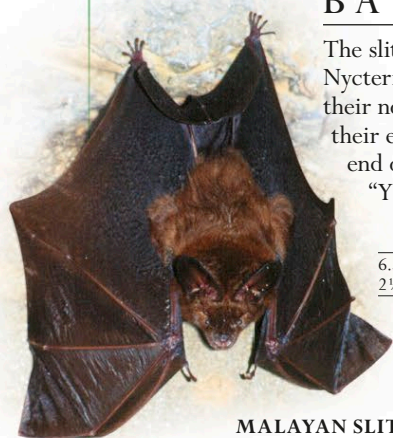
3.8–4.3 cm
1½–1¾ in

MEXICAN FUNNEL-EARED BAT
Natalus mexicanus

An insectivorous species, the Mexican funnel-eared bat lives in C. and S. America. It roosts in caves and, sometimes, also in abandoned mines.

SLIT-FACED BATS

The slit-faced bats of the family Nycteridae have a furrow from their nostrils to a pit between their eyes. The cartilage at the end of their tail ends in a "Y" shape.



6.5–7.5 cm
2½–3 in

MALAYAN SLIT-FACED BAT
Nycteris tragata

The facial furrow of this slit-faced bat helps to direct its echolocation calls. It is found in tropical forest in Myanmar, Malaysia, Sumatra, and Borneo.

MYSTACINIDAE

The one extant member of the Mystacinidae has extra talons on its thumb and toe claws. Its tough, leathery wings can be folded against the body when moving on the ground.



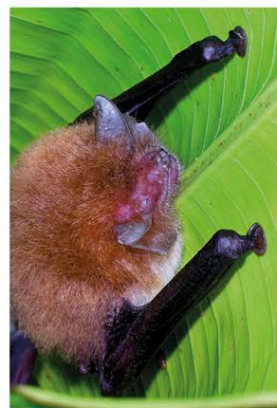
6–8 cm
2¼–3¼ in

LESSER NEW ZEALAND SHORT-TAILED BAT
Mystacina tuberculata

An agile mover on the ground, the New Zealand short-tailed bat sniffs out prey in leaf litter on the forest floor.

THYROPTERIDAE

The family Thyropteridae contains five species of disk-winged bats. Suction cups on the wrists and ankles allow them to attach to smooth-surfaced tropical leaves when roosting.



4–5 cm
1½–2 in

SPIX'S DISK-WINGED BAT
Thyroptera tricolor

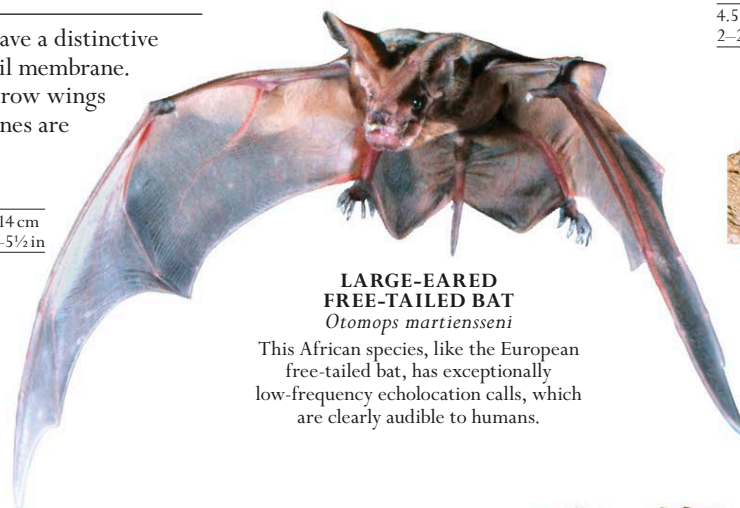
An insectivorous inhabitant of lowland forests from S. Mexico to S.E. Brazil, Spix's disk-winged bat roosts head upwards inside furred leaves.

MOLOSSIDAE

Free-tailed bats of the family Molossidae have a distinctive tail that extends beyond the edge of the tail membrane. They are robust, stocky bats with long narrow wings for fast flight. Their wing and tail membranes are particularly leathery.

8–9 cm
3¼–3½ in

11–14 cm
4½–5½ in



LARGE-EARED FREE-TAILED BAT
Otomops martiensseni

This African species, like the European free-tailed bat, has exceptionally low-frequency echolocation calls, which are clearly audible to humans.

EUROPEAN FREE-TAILED BAT
Tadarida teniotis

The only free-tailed bat to live in Europe, this bat's range extends from the Mediterranean to S. and S.E. Asia.

4.5–6.5 cm
2–2½ in



BRAZILIAN FREE-TAILED BAT
Tadarida brasiliensis

Colonies of the Mexican free-tailed bat roosting in caves and beneath bridges in Texas and Mexico can number in the millions.

MILLER'S MASTIFF BAT
Molossus pretiosus

An insectivorous bat of lowland dry forests, open savanna, and cactus scrub, Miller's mastiff bat is distributed from Mexico to Brazil.